GETTING PAID IN 2026

Only 48% of invoices get paid on time.

A year ago it was 58%.

Source: CreditorWatch Business Risk Index, September 2026

THE LONG TAIL

1 in 10 invoices are 60+ days overdue.

Double last year. The highest since April 2018.

Source: CreditorWatch Business Risk Index, September 2026

THEN COMES CHRISTMAS

30-day terms can turn into 60.

Invoice in early December. Customers shut for the break. The cash may not arrive until late January.

THE REAL PROBLEM

Not a people problem. A missing process.

Chasing lands on the owner, after hours, and only for the big invoices.

THREE BORING FIXES

1. **Invoice the day the job is done**
2. **Remind before and after the due date**
3. **Phone only at 30+ days overdue**

Reminders go out automatically. Same rules for every customer.

THE TAKEAWAY

Getting paid shouldn't depend on you remembering.